IES 9-008
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Espacio Curricular: Inglés Técnico I (Anual)

Curso: 2º año

Sedes: Ciudad/Las Heras

The Passive voice

Passive Voice

The **Active Voice** indicates that the subject of the verb carries out an action.

Jane wrote a letter.

Passive Voice:

- The Passive Voice indicates that something happens to the subject of the verb and the action is carried out by someone or something else.
  A letter was written by Jane.
- It is used when we are more interested in the action itself than in the person who carries it out or the thing that causes it.
  Two banks were robbed last night. *Lots of hamburgers are eaten every day.*

Notes:

- The person or thing that causes or carries out the action is called an **agent** and is preceded by the preposition **by**.
- When we use **by + agent**, we stress the person or thing that is responsible for the action.
- We omit **by + agent** when the agent is unknown or when it is easy to understand who or what causes the action. In this case, the subject in the Active Voice is usually a word such as **people**, **someone**, **one**, etc.

The Present Passive voice

Subjet + am/ is / are+ past particle+ complement.

We form the **Passive Voice** with the verb **be** in the appropriate tense and the **past participle** of the main verb.

Tense	Formation			Example
Present Simple	I am He/She/It	is	cleaned	*The office is cleaned every week.*
	We/You/They	are		

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The Past Passive Voice

Subject + was/were + Past Particle +complement
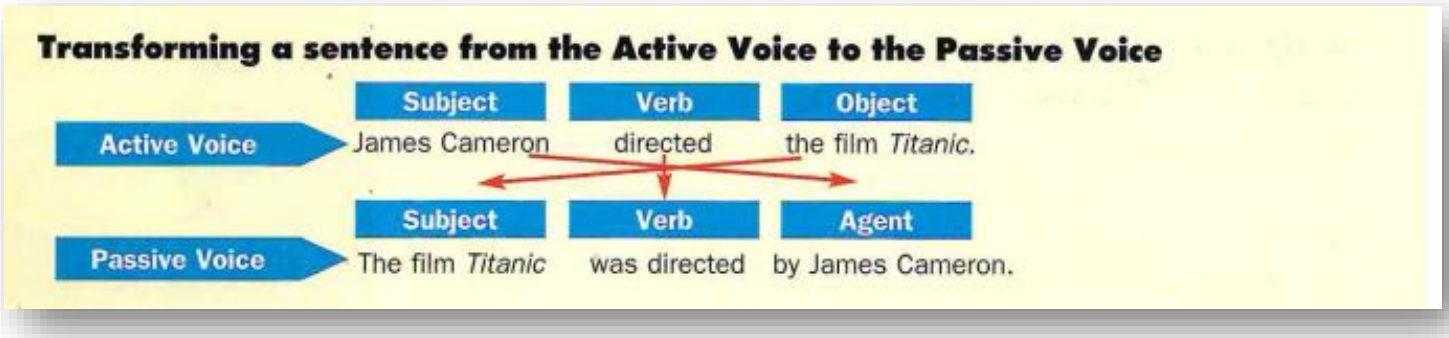
Past Simple	I/He/She/It We/You/They	was were	cleaned	*The office was cleaned yesterday.*

